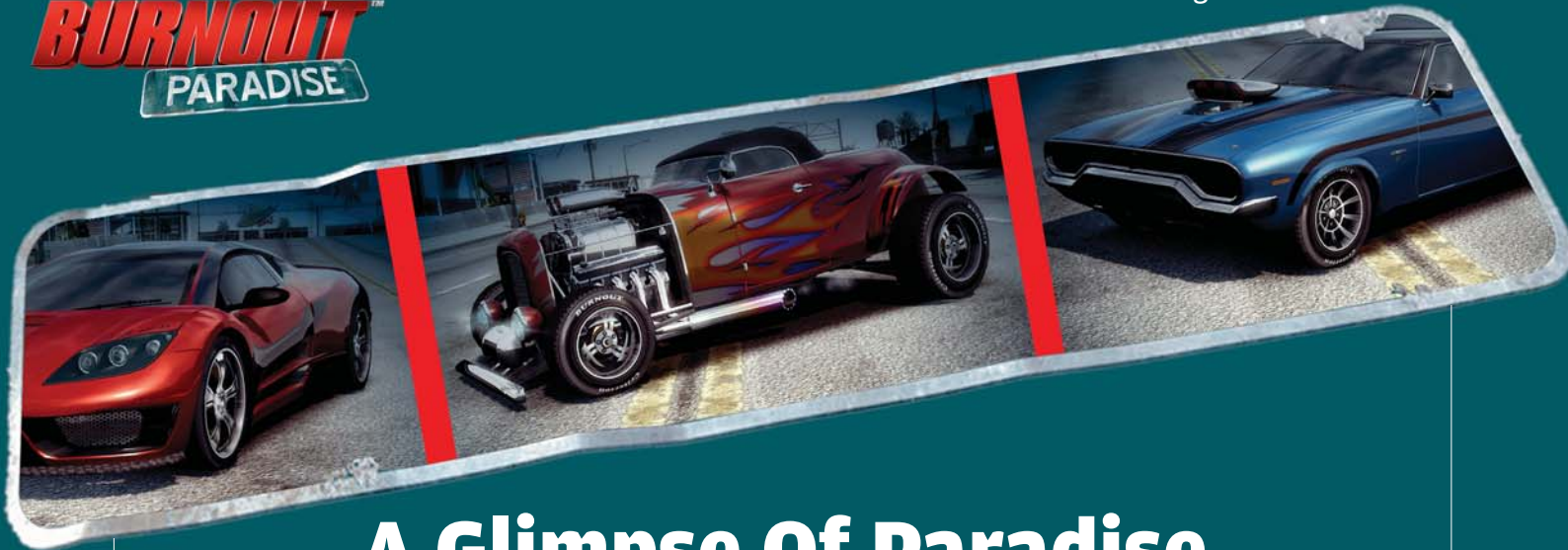




A Glimpse Of Paradise

Here at *Digit*, we've been quite happy with *Burnout: Revenge* and *Dominator*. Slamming rivals into walls and coming down on their heads from above never gets tired. Why, then, would Criterion even bother with a new title having already achieved its sadistic zenith?

We had us a little chat with Alex Ward, Creative Director at Criterion, to find out for ourselves. *Burnout: Paradise* will naturally be the best-looking game of the series, but it's the new features we can't wait for...

Some choice pickings:

On Paradise:

What we're out to achieve with the new game is to take the Burnout experience to a new place.

The main themes of this development centre around freedom and freedom to play Burnout however you would

like to. This is your Burnout at your pace. Now you are free to do whatever you want whenever you want to do it. We want to remove the restrictions of the old generation of hardware and break with many conventions.

Burnout: Paradise is the biggest open-world game EA has ever made, with everything open from the start; you can go anywhere and do anything from the get-go, and your first hour of play will be totally different from other players'.

I personally enjoyed playing the game *Mercenaries*, where I got a kick out of doing things I was not really supposed to be doing. *Burnout: Paradise* offers a similar sensation, exploring the city, playing with different types of cars, hanging with buddies, doing massive drifts, jumping from roof to roof—anything you can think of.

On The New Features:

Because *Burnout: Paradise* is a completely open world, there is no more jumping back and forth from menu to go into different race modes. There is no such thing as “modes” anymore—every “mode” is seamless, and an extension of your driving experience. The state of driving freely in the open world is called “Free Burn,” during which you can drive around exploring the city and discovering new areas and hidden gimmicks. At any time while Free-burning, you can choose to engage in various racing experiences:

Road Rules

Each road has a set of best records for who drove fastest and who caused the biggest crash—beat your friends' scores to rule the road!

Race

Each traffic light in the game represents a different game, and you can choose (or not) to participate in any race with absolutely no loading time.

Crash

We re-invented this experience so you can go into crashes with a push of a button at anytime, anywhere. This new crash experience is called *Show Time*. The objective of Show Time is to time your crash so you can keep flying and move forward, while crashing your car into a pulp—the distance you can travel while crashing will determine your score.



Alex Ward
Creative Director, Criterion

Marked Man And Payback

When playing with multiple players online, you can decide to “mark” certain player and go after him together. Taking down a “marked” player will let you earn a special trophy as a collectible item.

To be fair to the marked man, we offer these players a chance for a comeback by giving them a special ability called “Payback.” These randomly-chosen abilities include pulling stunts on other players like reversing their controls, taking away their breaks and boosts, and such—just fun gimmicks to allow players to have fun messing with each other.

Watch these pages for our review when the game is released for the PS3 and Xbox 360 in November this year!

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